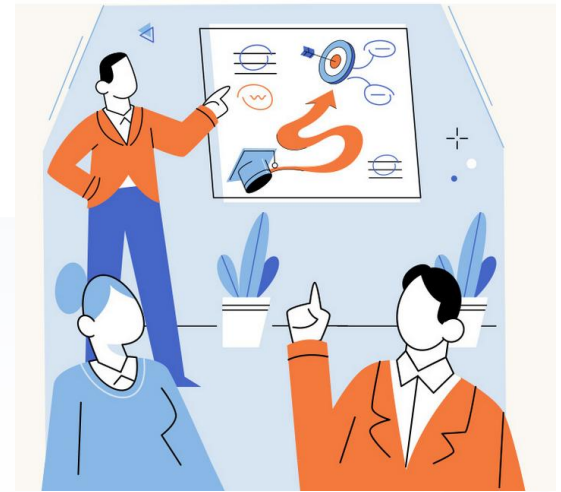




Prof. Dr.-Ing. Lamyia Abdullah Lamyia.Abdullah@provadis-hochschule.de

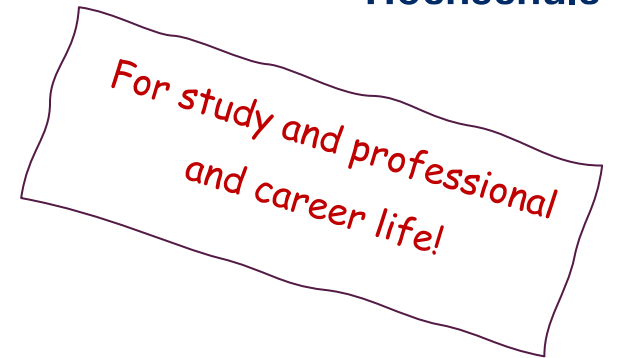
Interkulturelle Kommunikation und heterogene Teams
Lecture Notes- 07: Presentation Skills + Wrapping up



Presentation as a Professional Skill

Learning Objectives

- Adapt a presentation to a **diverse audience**
- Structure a message so that it is **clear, logical, and memorable**
- Balance **content, visuals, and delivery**
- Recognize how cultural expectations can influence presentation styles
- Present technical/professional information **without losing** the audience
- Handle **questions, disagreement, and uncertainty** professionally
- Use presentation skills to build **credibility and trust**



Why Presentation Is a **Professional Skill** ?

A **professional** presentation is a tool for:

- **Informing** : What does the audience **need** to know?
- **Explaining** : Can I make a **complex** idea understandable?
- **Persuading** : Why should the audience **agree** or **act**?
- **Aligning** : Can different people leave with the **same understanding**?
- **Building credibility** : Do I appear **competent** and **trustworthy**?
- **Enabling decisions** : Can my presentation **help** people **decide**?

Presentation ≠ PowerPoint
Or Slides by AI...

Examples?

A good presentation is **not** about showing what you know.
It is about helping the **audience understand what matters?**

Why Presentation Skills Matter?

Technical **expertise** alone is often **not** enough.

Professionals must be able to:

- **communicate** ideas clearly
- **persuade** stakeholders
- explain **complex** issues
- work **across** cultures
- adapt to **different** audiences

Have you ever attended a **presentation** that was **technically correct** but **difficult to follow**?

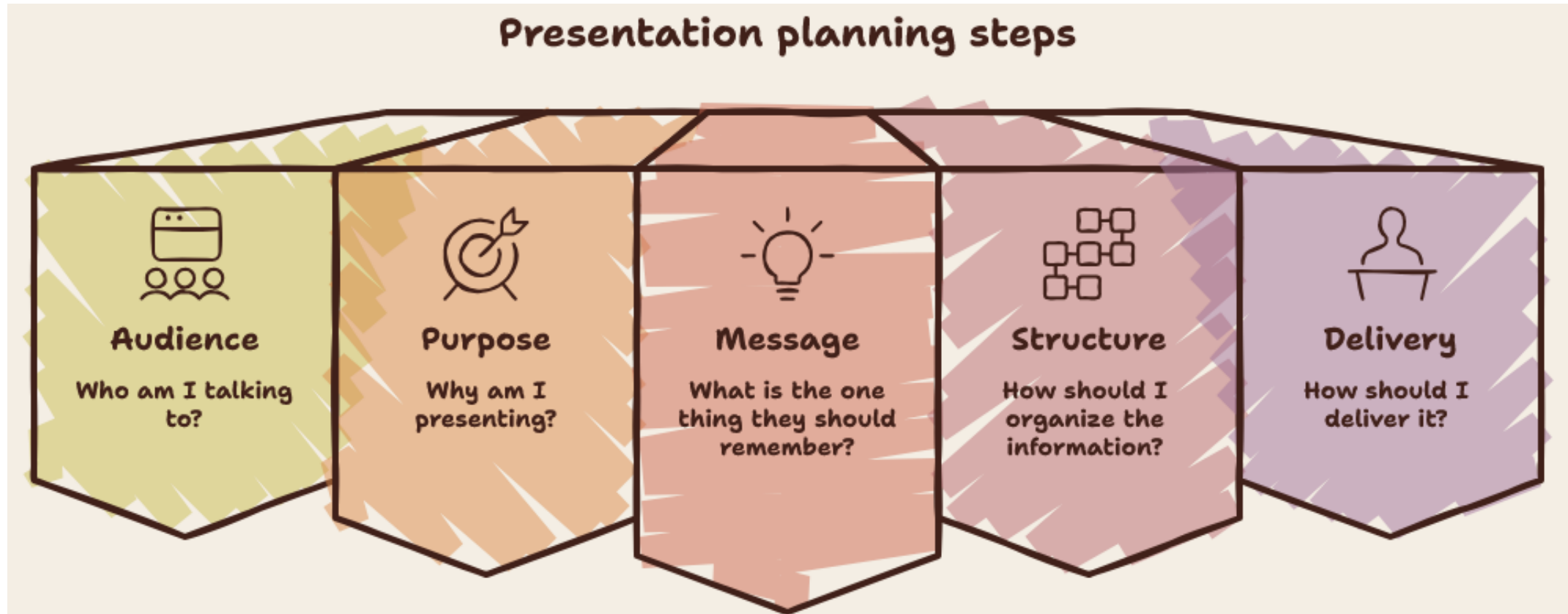
It is **particularly relevant** in heterogeneous teams because **people** may **differ** in:

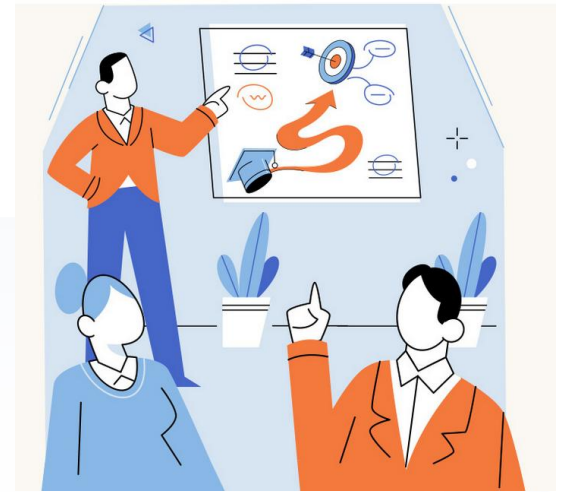
- **technical** background
- **language** proficiency
- **communication** preferences
- expectations of **hierarchy**
- tolerance for **ambiguity**
- attitudes toward **disagreement**
- preferred level of **detail**

The Professional Presentation Mindset

From "What I **want** to say" → "What **they need** to understand"

Weak starting point	Professional starting point
What do I know ?	What does my audience need?
What should I show ?	What should they understand?
How many slides do I need?	What decision/action should result?
How can I demonstrate expertise?	How can I make the message useful ?
What information can I include ?	What information can I remove ?





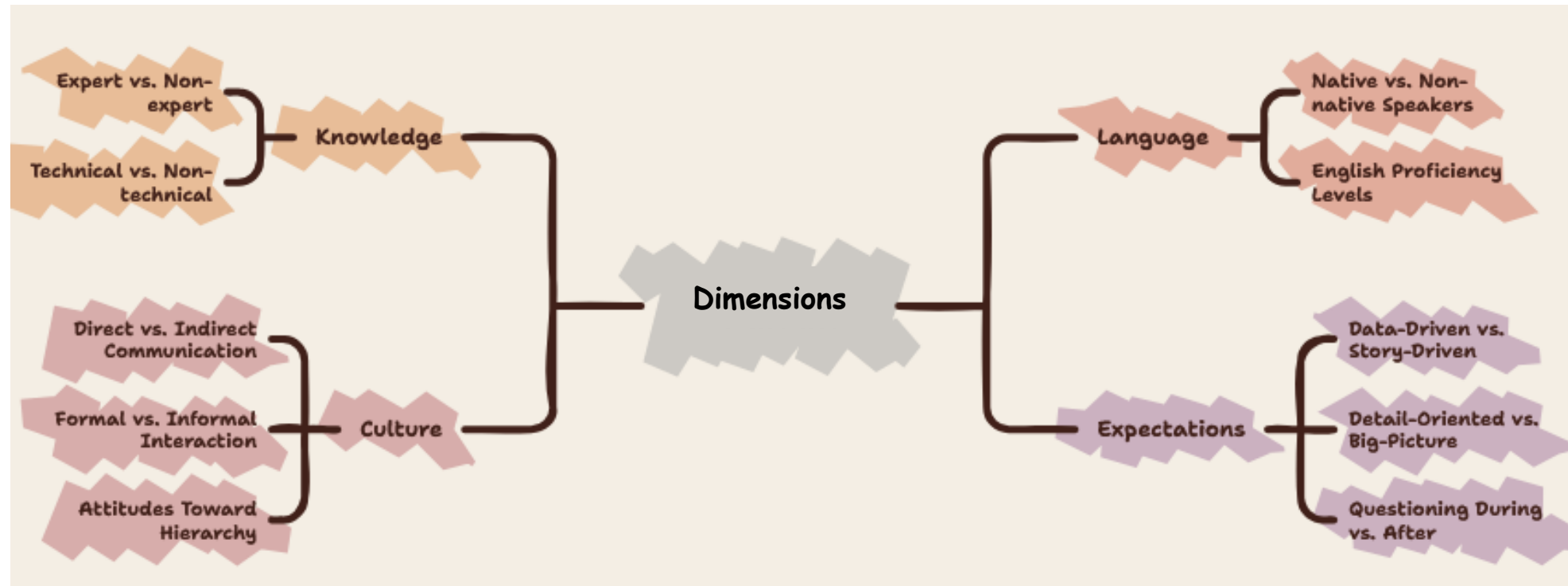
Presenting to a Heterogeneous Audience

Know your Audience

One Presentation $\neq$ One Audience

Imagine presenting the **same project** to:

- ☐ German engineering students
- ☐ international business students
- ☐ a professor
- ☐ an industry manager
- ☐ a customer
- ☐ a multicultural project team

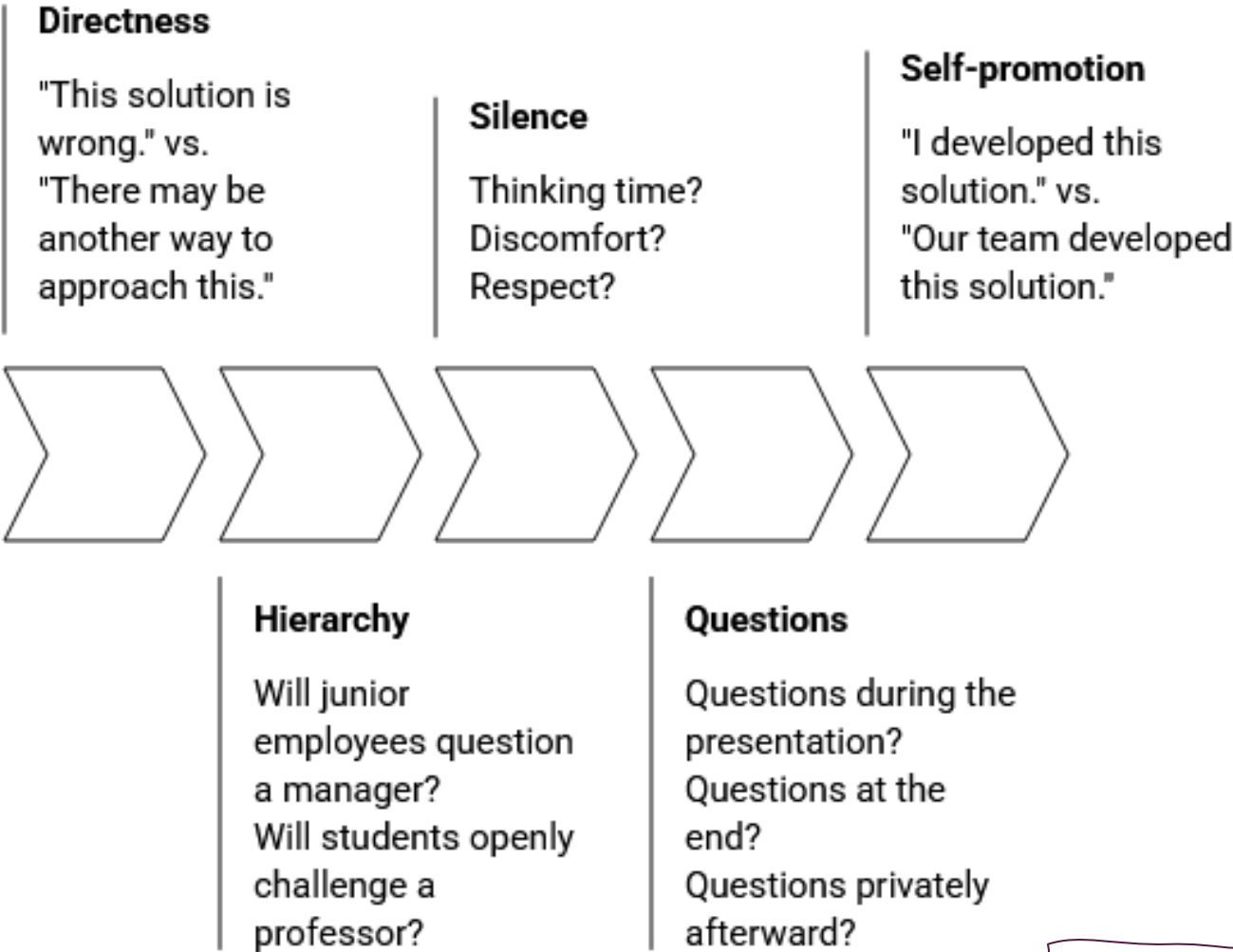


The **content** may remain **similar**, but the **presentation** should **change**.

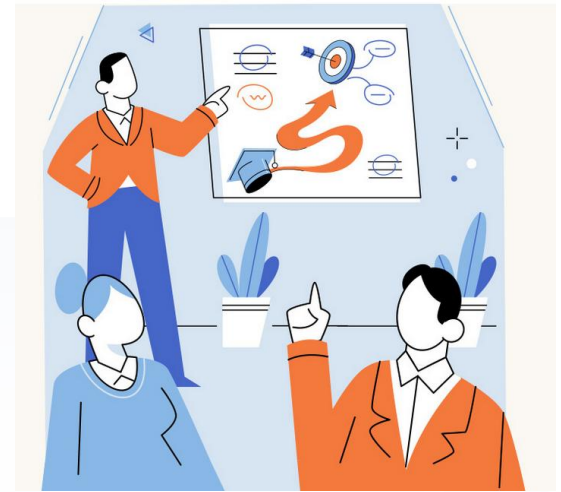
→ Adapt the communication ... **not** your **authenticity**.

Cultural Differences in Presentation Styles

Cultural **Patterns** ≠ Cultural **Rules**



Cultural **frameworks** help us **anticipate** possibilities, **not predict individuals**



The Message Architecture

- **WHY?**

What problem/opportunity are we addressing?

- **WHAT?**

What did we discover/propose?

- **HOW?**

How does it work?

- **SO WHAT?**

Why does it matter?

What should the audience do?

Example

Instead of:

**Background → Literature → Methodology → Results → Discussion
→ Conclusion**

[which is useful in scientific work]

Use:

Problem → Insight → Solution → Evidence → Recommendation

[which is useful for engineering/CS with technical details]

Storytelling: Give Information a Meaning

Storytelling ≠ entertainment

In professional presentations, storytelling helps the audience understand:

- What happened?
- Why does it matter?
- What did we learn/do?

Simple structure

SITUATION → CHALLENGE → ACTION → RESULT
→ LESSON

Facts inform..... Stories create meaning.

Example:

- “Our team **experienced** several communication **problems**.” 
- “During the first **two weeks**, our team had **four misunderstandings** about task **responsibilities**. We **changed** how we organized our meetings, and communication **improved significantly**.” 

Don't just **present information** ... But create a **journey**.

Instead of:

Problem → Method → Results → Conclusion

Try:

**HOOK → CONTEXT → CHALLENGE → INSIGHT →
EVIDENCE → ACTION**

Example opening:

*“We **initially** thought the technical part would be the **biggest** challenge. It wasn’t.*

Our first major problem was communication within the team.”

Then connect the story to your **data, analysis, and recommendation**.

Professional storytelling should be:

- **Relevant** : supports the main message
- **Concise** : no unnecessary details
- **Authentic** : do not invent experiences
- **Audience-centered** : adapted to who is listening

Storytelling in Intercultural Teams

The **same** story can be interpreted **differently**.

When presenting to a heterogeneous audience, consider:

- What **examples** are familiar to them?
- How much **context** do they need?
- What **communication** style is expected?
- Could the story or **humor** be misunderstood?
- What **values** or **assumptions** are embedded in the story?

→ Adapt the **story** to the audience — **without** reducing people to cultural **stereotypes**

Mini-activity – story telling ~ 10-15 mins

Turn facts into a story:

- ☐ 5 team members
- ☐ 3 nationalities
- ☐ 4 communication problems
- ☐ changed meeting structure
- ☐ successful project

• Challenge:

Create a **30-second story** using:

Situation → Challenge → Action → Result → Lesson

Mini-Activity — Same Story, Different Audience

Your **multicultural** team has completed a project successfully, but during the project:

- ☐ 5 team members
- ☐ 3 nationalities
- ☐ Different communication styles
- ☐ Several misunderstandings
- ☐ Team changed its meeting approach
- ☐ Collaboration improved
- ☐ Project delivered successfully

Challenge

Create a **30-second professional story** using:

Situation → Challenge → Action → Result → Lesson

Then adapt the **same story** for one of these audiences:

A. Your Professor

Focus on learning, analysis, and evidence.

B. A Company Manager

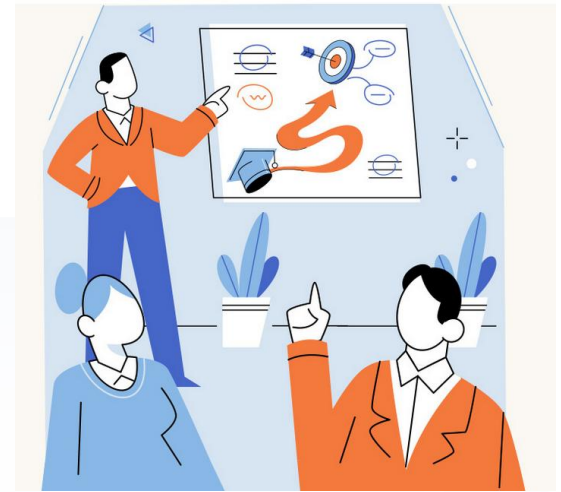
Focus on results, efficiency, and lessons for future teams.

C. A New International Team

Focus on practical advice and collaboration.

What changed when the audience changed?

Vocabulary
level of detail
Emphasis
Examples
Directness
what counts as a "good" result



Professional Presentation

Collection of principles and tips

Principles and Tips

- The "One Message per Slide" Principle

Not necessarily "one fact," but **one idea**.

- Title matters:

Example: not really good slide title:

Cybersecurity Risk Analysis

Better:

Remote Access Creates the Highest-Risk Attack Path

The second title already **communicates the conclusion**.

- The slide should support your speech; **not** replace it.

- Do **not** Make the Audience **Work**

Example:

Weak

Results

- Risk 1: 6
- Risk 2: 4
- Risk 3: 8
- Risk 4: 3

Stronger

Remote PLC access represents our **highest-priority** risk

Slides Are Visual Support

Can this be understood faster **visually** than verbally?

Use:

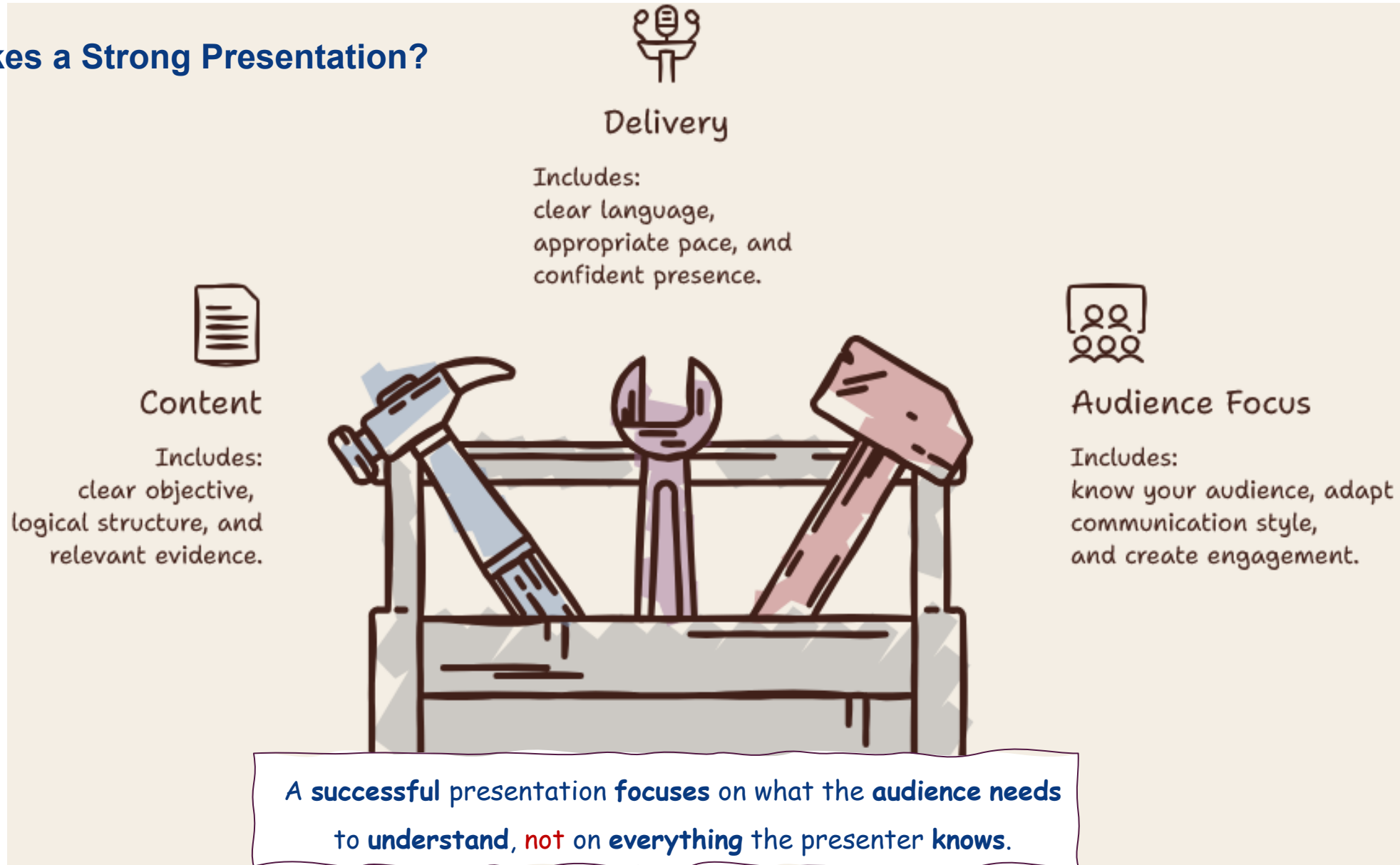
- diagrams
- process flows
- comparisons
- timelines
- simple charts
- meaningful images
- highlighted numbers

Avoid:

- paragraphs
- excessive bullet points
- decorative graphics
- tiny text
- tables containing everything you know

Remarks: What Makes a Strong Presentation?

3 Success Factors The three Layers Model



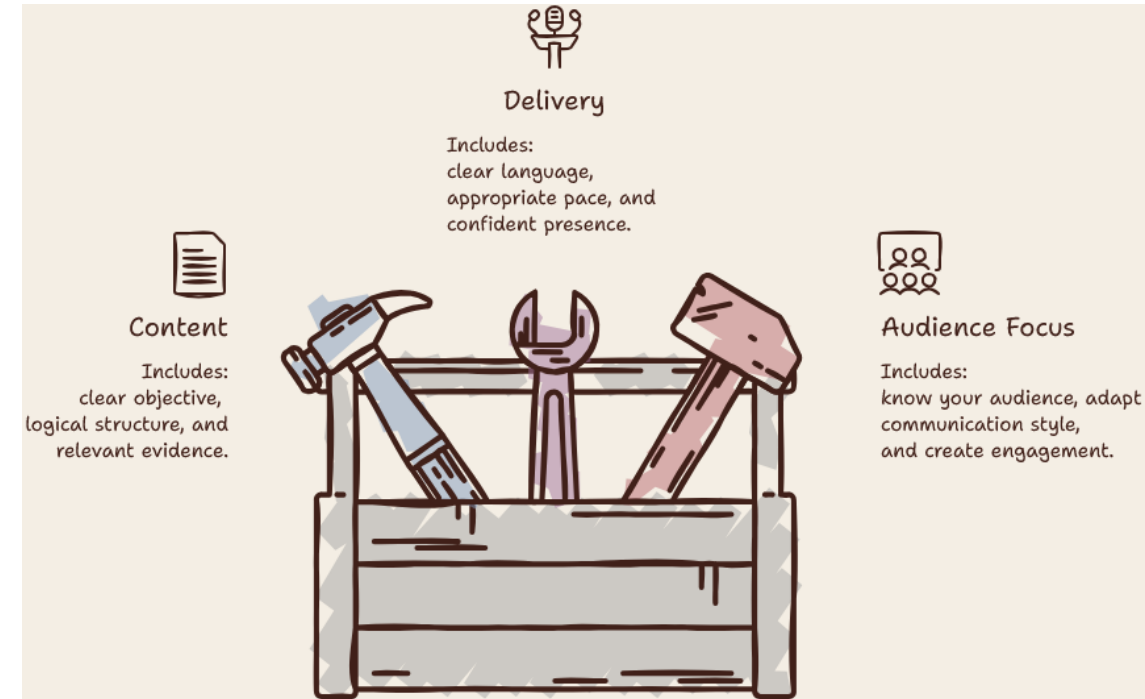
Remarks: What Makes a Strong Presentation?

3 Success Factors

The three Layers Model

If one fails:

- Great content + **poor** delivery → **confusing**
- Great delivery + **poor** content → **entertaining** but empty
- Great slides + **poor** explanation → presentation becomes "**reading slides**"
- Great presentation + **wrong** audience adaptation → technically correct but **ineffective**



Handling Questions

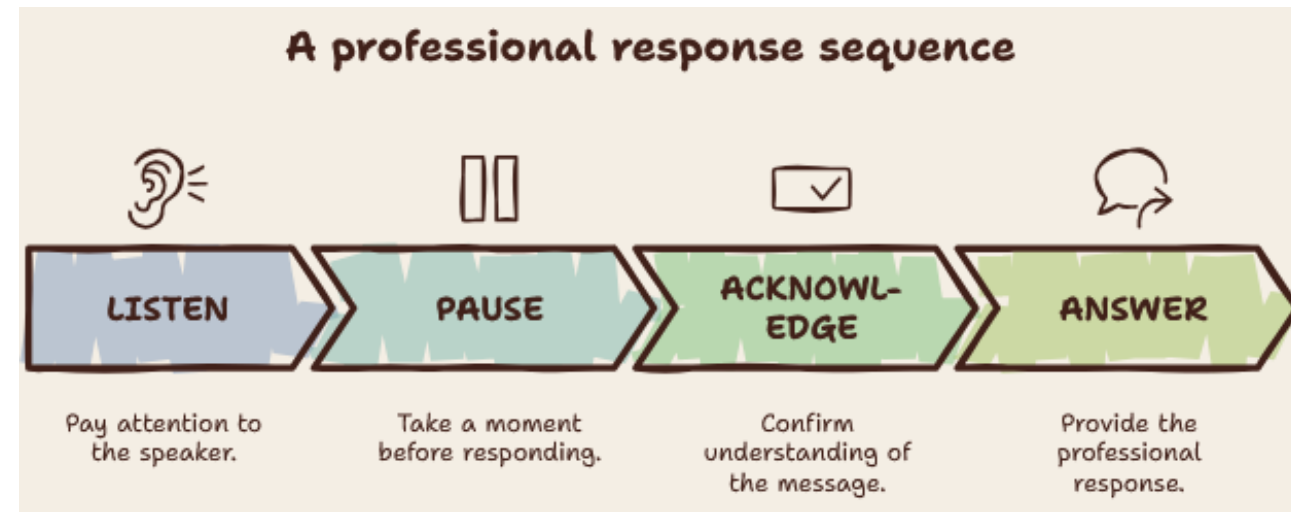
Questions Are natural Part of the Presentation

→ should **not** interpret every question as **criticism**.

A question may mean:

- genuine curiosity
- disagreement
- clarification
- testing your argument
- cultural expectation to interact
- desire to contribute

We do **not** need to know everything to appear **competent**.
Sometimes: "**I don't know**." is more **professional** than **inventing** an answer.



Example:

- "That's an important point."
- "If I understand correctly, you're asking whether..."
- "Our current data suggests..."

or:

- "I do **not** have that information at the moment, but I would **investigate** it."

When You Don't Agree

Avoid:

"No, that's wrong."

Try:

- "I see your point. Our analysis, however, suggests ..."

or:

- "That's one possible interpretation. We approached it differently because ..."

or:

- "Could you clarify what **aspect** you mean?"

Defend the idea **without attacking** the person.

Challenge: Same Message — Different Audience

A message: **"Our team rejected the proposed solution because the security risks are too high."**

Imagine presenting it to:

- A. Your professor**
- B. An international project team**
- C. A senior manager**
- D. A client**

How would you change:

- wording?
- level of detail?
- directness?
- evidence?
- recommendation?

Challenge: Same Message — Different Audience, cont.

A message: **"Our team rejected the proposed solution because the security risks are too high."**

Possible framing:

A. To a professor:

"Our analysis indicates that the proposed solution introduces significant security risks."

B. International Project Team

"After **reviewing** the proposed solution, our team identified several significant security risks. We **don't** think it is the best option in its current form, so we suggest looking at alternative approaches together."

C. To a manager:

"We recommend not proceeding with the proposed solution because the associated security risk exceeds our acceptable level."

D. To a client:

"Based on our assessment, we recommend an alternative approach that provides a better security-risk balance."

Mini Activity: Improve the Presentation

Project Results (slide)

Our project was very successful and we learned many things.

We implemented the system using Python.

There were several challenges during development.

We also tested the system with different users.

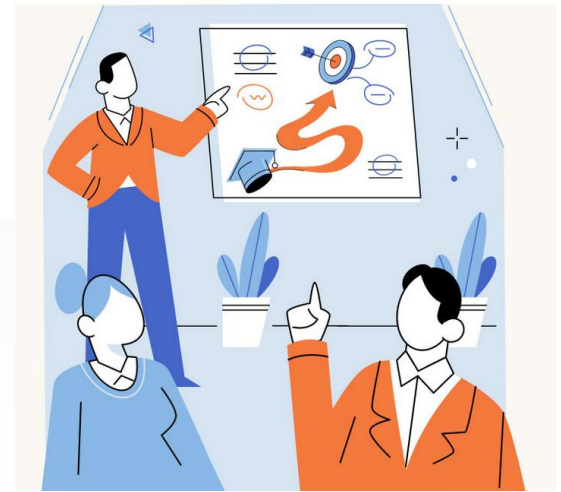
The results were mostly positive.

Thank you.

What would you change?

Main principles:

- What is the **main** message?
- What **evidence** supports it?
- What should the **audience** remember?
- What should be **visual**?
- What should the **presenter** say rather than **write**?



Professional Presentation

Final Remarks!

PRESENTATION SKILLS FOR **PERSUASIVE PRESENTATIONS**

IDENTIFYING
PROBLEMS AND NEEDS



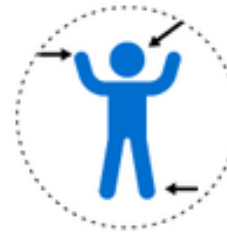
ELABORATING
"THE HOOK"



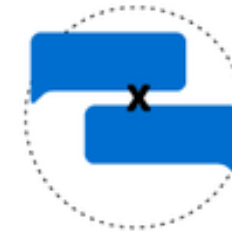
KNOWING HOW TO
"TIE" YOUR AUDIENCE



KNOWLEDGE OF
BODY LANGUAGE



PREPARE TO DEFEND
YOUR POINT OF VIEW



HANDLING REJECTION



CONVERT OPPORTUNITIES
INTO NEW PROJECTS



HAVING
CONFIDENCE



USE OF HUMOR
AND OTHER ELEMENTS



SUMMARIZE
INFORMATION IN
VISUALLY APPEALING WAYS



<https://slidemodel.com/presentation-skills-guide/>

Mitigating Risk Through Preparation!

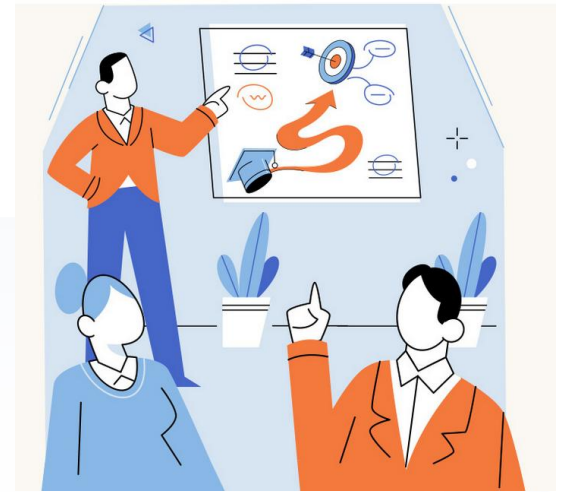
Reading

- **Presentation Skills 101: A Guide to Presentation Success, 2024**

<https://slidemodel.com/presentation-skills-guide/>

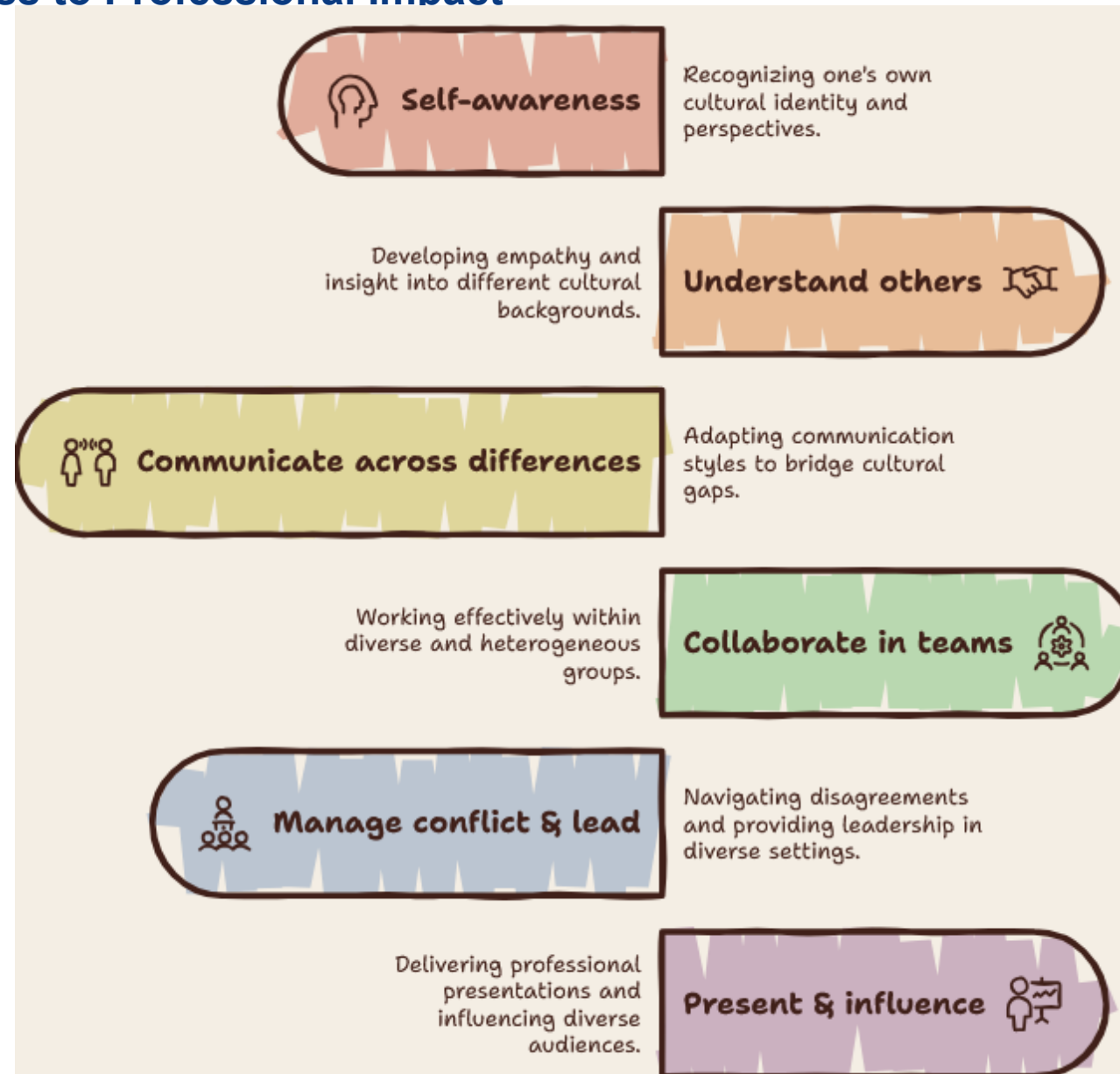


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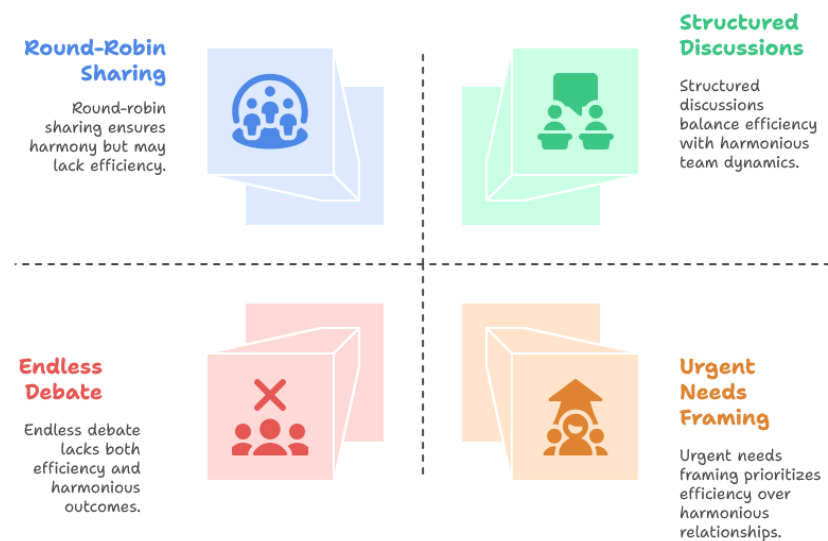


Wrapping Up!

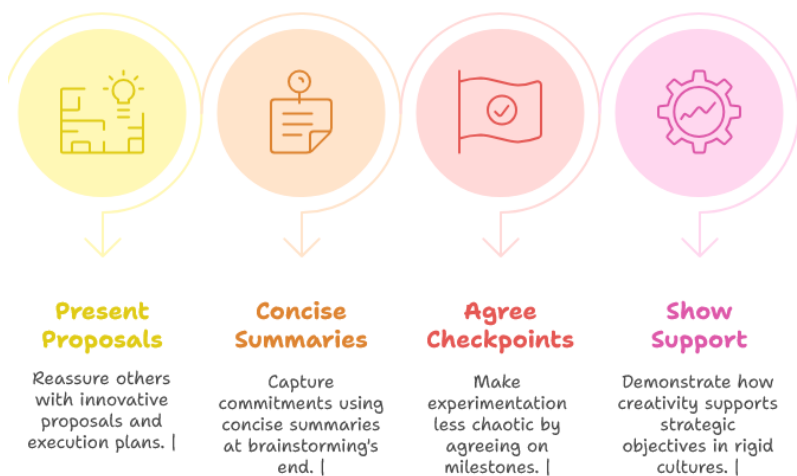
From Intercultural Awareness to Professional Impact



1. Clan Culture (Collaborate / Family)



2. Adhocracy Culture (Create / Dynamic)



3. Market Culture (Compete / Results-Oriented)

Provide context for goals

Providing context helps motivate goals despite low trust.



Acknowledge contributions

Acknowledging contributions fosters trust and motivates goals.



Push for targets without listening

Pushing targets without listening undermines trust and motivation.

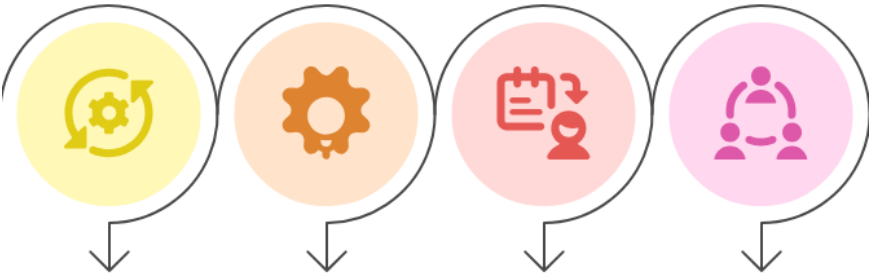


Balance KPI with values

Balancing KPI with values builds trust but lacks motivation.



4. Hierarchy Culture (Control / Structured)



Simplify rules

Focus on essential processes for collaborators. This ensures smoother external interactions.

Adapt processes

Demonstrate flexibility for innovation while maintaining standards. This balances progress and motivation.

Structured agendas

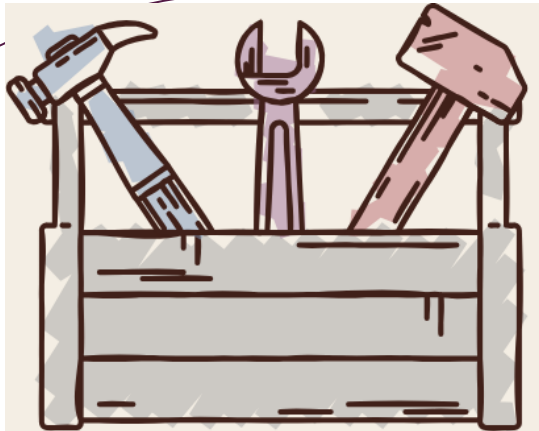
Use agendas, but allow room for open discussion. This combines organization with adaptability.

Communicate benefits

Explain how stability and structure enable success. This builds trust and understanding.

Reflection & Takeaways !

Tools,
Assessments and
Strategies !



Besides the grades ...

What do I do with this knowledge?

It does not end here!

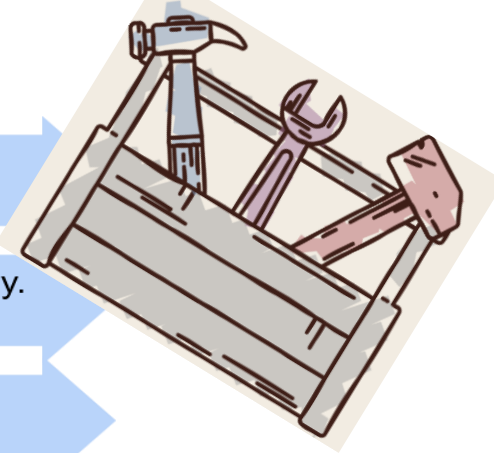


Any Questions ?

[professionalPresentation.pdf](#) uploaded on Teams

Key Professional Behaviours for Modern Workplace

Polite Behaviour	Say "Good morning," "Goodbye," "Thank you," and "Please." A polite way of interacting with each other should be a matter of course.
Reliability	Keep promises and perform tasks with due diligence. Take deadlines seriously. Outcome: This is how YOU score points with bosses and colleagues.
Helpfulness	Offer help to people who are under stress. Outcome: This is how YOU earn extra credit.
Resilience	Keep your nerve and act deliberately, even in difficult situations. Outcome: This skill is worth its weight in gold!
Teamwork	Lone wolves are "out." In a company, you are a team player. Everyone works together and supports each other.
Conflict Resolution	Keep a cool head during disputes, even though it is difficult. Say your opinion without hurting others.
Receptiveness to Criticism	If you are criticized, listen carefully. Criticism should not offend you but show you what you can do better.
Willingness to Learn	As an apprentice, you will discover many new things. Outcome: The more you know, the more confident you will become.
Mindfulness	Be an attentive conversational partner. Listen to other people and let them finish talking.
Respect	Respect should be a matter of course. Be respectful even if a colleague's behaviour or appearance seems alien.



A low-angle, blue-tinted photograph of a group of graduates in black gowns. They are all looking upwards with expressions of joy and excitement, their arms raised. Several black graduation caps are captured mid-air, having just been tossed. The background is a bright, clear sky.

Your Report Presentation

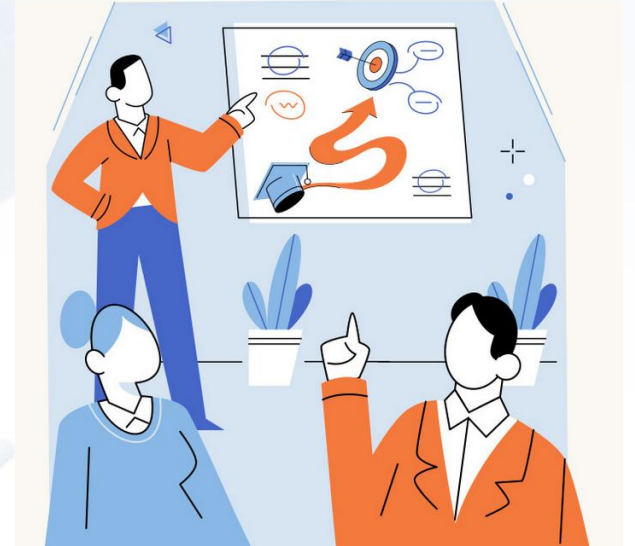
About Presentation

Practice Practice Practice!!
for your presentation for better time
management.

A well-organized presentation keeps your audience engaged and helps them understand your use case.

Tell the Story (Only Suggestions and ideas):

- **Title & Introduction** – Case title, context teaser
- **Overview** – Summary, setting, goals
- **Team Composition** – Size, backgrounds, roles
- **Communication Styles** – Observed patterns, mismatches
- **Story** – Short timeline of events
- **Challenges** – 2–5 key intercultural/heterogeneous issues
- **Theory Applied** – Model used to analyse (e.g., Hofstede, Belbin, GRPI, ...)
- **Solutions / Strategies** – What was done or proposed
- **Outcome** – Results achieved, unresolved issues
- **Lessons Learned** – Main takeaways
- **Reflection & Next Steps** – Recommendations
- **References / Appendix** – Sources, visuals



Presentation:

Time: 8-9 mins => Q&A

Presenters: All of the Group members



Any Questions ?